the Depression hit, they had entered college rather than sit on their porch, unemployed.

At a chalk-talk before one game, Mac McKinzie asked the team if any of us prayed.

I had never faced a kickoff without a prayer. I didn’t pray to win—I didn’t expect God to take sides—but I prayed no one would be injured, we’d all do our best and have no regrets no matter how the game came out.

But I was afraid to reveal this to my older and more sophisticated teammates. Then, to my amazement, everyone in the room said that they prayed—and to my surprise, they all said they prayed along the same lines that I did.

That was the last time I was ever reluctant to admit I prayed.